

The Fun Family History of Custom GPTs

Explore how custom GPTs enhance the capabilities of the base GPT models on which they are built. Then get familiar with some notable custom GPTs across various categories.



ChatGPT was introduced on November 30, 2022. I began experimenting with it soon after and managed to publish an article in the January 2023 issue of *Open Source For You*. (Since then, I have often claimed that this was the first instance of a print magazine in India mentioning ChatGPT.) In fact, I became so enthusiastic about it that whenever I mentioned ChatGPT in class, my students would burst into laughter.

Being obsessed with ChatGPT right from its inception, I have been closely following its evolution—almost like a father watching his newborn grow. The journey of ChatGPT from using GPT-3.5 to GPT-4, then to GPT-4.5, and now GPT-5 has been nothing short of thrilling. But alongside this impressive progression, I have also been fascinated by the explosion of custom GPTs—versions of ChatGPT with focus on specific domains. These custom GPTs are created by OpenAI as well as the wider community.

Custom GPTs are tailored for specific tasks, personalities, or domains of expertise. There are now hundreds of them, with new ones appearing every day. Interestingly, while many of them are highly practical and well-designed, some seem oddly counter-intuitive—or even counter-productive.

Before we dive deeper, it is important to put things into perspective: why is an article about GPTs (generative pre-trained transformers) relevant to a magazine like *OSFY*, which focuses on